

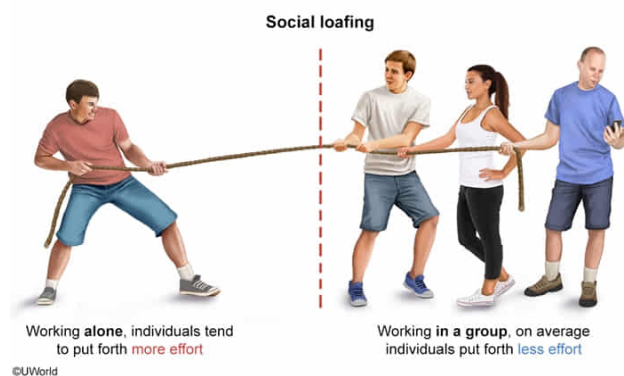
Some experts suggest that the benefits of teamwork may be outweighed by an average loss of productivity per team member. This productivity loss can best be explained by which of the following group processes?

- ✓ ☒ A. Social loafing [92%]
☐ B. Groupthink [3%]
☐ C. Conformity [1%]
☐ D. Group polarization [2%]

Correct

93% answered correctly

Explanation:



Social loafing occurs when an individual **exerts less effort** while working **in a group** versus working alone. For example, when asked to pull as hard as possible on a rope, people tend to pull harder by themselves than when others are also pulling. Research suggests that factors such as group size and motivation or interest in the group task may impact the degree to which individuals engage in social loafing.

The reduced effort exerted by individuals as a result of social loafing often translates into a loss of group productivity. In this example, experts are comparing the benefits of teamwork (ie, working in a group) to the potential drawback of social loafing (ie, the productivity loss of individuals in a team setting).

(Choice B) Groupthink occurs when a desire for group cohesion or consensus results in poor decision-making. Groupthink is not defined by an average loss of productivity per team member.

(Choice C) Conformity occurs when individual group members align their thoughts or actions with the group. Conformity is not defined by an average loss of productivity per team member.

(Choice D) Group polarization occurs when group members' average attitudes/opinions become more extreme after group discussion. Group polarization is not defined by an average loss of productivity per team member.

Educational objective:

Social loafing occurs when individuals expend less effort as part of a group than they would if working alone. The extent to which social loafing occurs is influenced by various factors, such as group size, motivation, or interest in the group task.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401663

System:
Identity and Social Interaction

A medical resident emulates the behaviors and mannerisms of the attending physicians. She also volunteers for multiple committees in an attempt to impress these physicians. Which aspects of social interaction are represented in this scenario?

- ☐ A. Primary group and looking-glass self
- ☐ B. Reference group and looking-glass self [8%]
- ☐ C. Primary group and impression management [6%]
- ✓ ☒ D. Reference group and impression management [84%]

Correct

84% answered correctly

Explanation:

Types of groups	
In-group	- Group to which an individual identifies & belongs - Other in-group members viewed favorably
Out-group	- Group to which an individual does not identify or belong - Out-group members viewed unfavorably
Reference group	- Comparison group to which an individual compares self - Individual may or may not <i>belong</i> to this group
Primary group	- Group of individuals who are emotionally close - Smaller in size, high degree of interaction (eg, family)
Secondary group	- Group of individuals who come together to accomplish something - Larger in size, more impersonal (eg, coworkers)

A **reference group** is used as a **standard of comparison** for one's beliefs and behaviors. Individuals compare themselves to members of their own reference group (eg, comparing one's MCAT study habits to those of other

pre-meds) or to those of other reference groups to which they aspire (eg, comparing one's MCAT study habits to those of top MCAT scorers). Individuals often emulate aspirational reference group members and typically have many different reference groups.

Impression management involves trying to **influence** how one is **perceived by others** by employing certain behaviors (eg, covering one's tattoos for a medical school interview). Individuals usually attempt to generate a positive impression, but not always (eg, a prisoner may flaunt tattoos in an attempt to inspire fear in other inmates).

Imitation of a reference group best explains a medical resident *emulating the behaviors and mannerisms* of the attending physicians. Impression management best explains her volunteering for multiple committees *in an attempt to impress* these physicians.

(Choices A, B, and C) Primary groups are composed of individuals with whom people have close and enduring relationships that involve frequent contact (eg, close friends, family). Looking-glass self describes the way our interpretation of how others perceive us impacts our self-concept (beliefs about ourselves). Primary groups and looking-glass self are not represented in this scenario.

Educational objective:

Individuals use reference groups as a standard of comparison for their beliefs and behaviors. Individuals often have many reference groups, to which they may belong or aspire to belong. Impression management is the process of attempting to influence how one is perceived by others, often with the goal of being perceived favorably.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401664
System:
Identity and Social Interaction

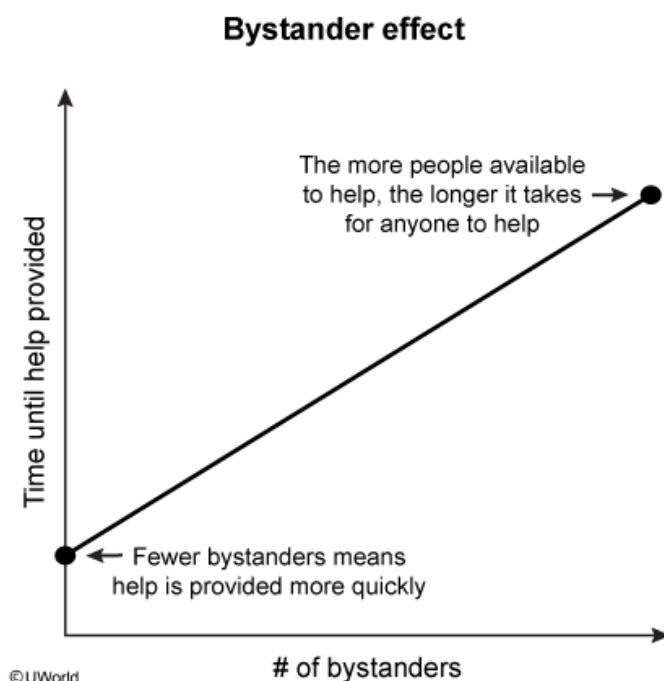
A social psychologist employs a confederate to pretend to have a heart attack in a crowded train station, then measures how long it takes for the confederate to receive help. The study procedure is repeated over multiple trials throughout the day. This experiment is most likely evaluating which phenomenon and with what independent variable, respectively?

- ☐ A. Bystander effect; amount of time until someone attempts to help the confederate [37%]
- ✓ ☒ B. Bystander effect; number of onlookers [60%]
- ☐ C. Hawthorne effect; amount of time until someone attempts to help the confederate [1%]
- ☐ D. Hawthorne effect; number of onlookers

Correct

61% answered correctly

Explanation:



The **bystander effect** occurs when an individual in need is **less likely to receive help** when more people are present. This is partly explained by **diffusion of responsibility**, the tendency for people in groups to assume that action will be taken by someone else. In other words, everyone assumes someone else will step in (diffusion of responsibility), so no one ends up taking any action (bystander effect).

This study was designed to evaluate the bystander effect. The researcher likely hypothesized that a greater *number of onlookers present* (independent variable) in the train station would result in a longer amount of time until someone attempts to help the confederate (dependent variable).

(Choice A) The amount of time it takes for someone to help the confederate is the dependent (not independent) variable because it is the outcome (effect) that the researcher is measuring.

(Choices C and D) The Hawthorne effect describes research subjects acting different from how they would normally behave as a result of knowing that they are being observed. In order for the Hawthorne effect to occur in this scenario, the onlookers in the subway station would need to know they were being observed, which is not indicated here.

Educational objective:

The bystander effect predicts that as the number of onlookers increases, the probability of an onlooker helping someone in need decreases. This can be partly explained by the diffusion of responsibility, whereby onlookers assume action will be taken by someone else.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401665
System:
Identity and Social Interaction